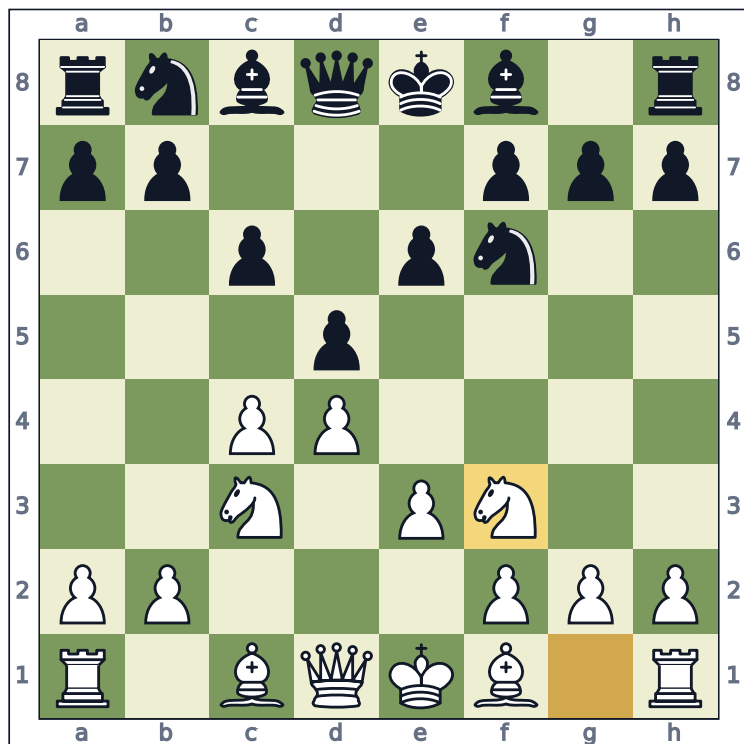


## QUEEN'S GAMBIT STRUCTURES

# Semi-Slav Defense

ECO D45 | 15 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

## IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

## ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.42 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

## GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

## WHAT THIS OPENING IS

D45 covers Semi-Slav Defense. White uses c4 to challenge Black's d5 pawn and seeks lasting central or queenside pressure. The diagram uses the featured line Semi-Slav Defense: Main Line.

## DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3

## UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

# What both sides are trying to achieve

**WHITE'S GOALS**

Recover or transform the c-pawn investment, complete development, and choose between a central break and minority play.

**BLACK'S GOALS**

Maintain a sound d5 point, free the c8 bishop, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 before passivity sets in.

**PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING**

Black's ...c5 and ...e5 are freeing breaks; White commonly uses e4, cxd5, or b4-b5 in minority structures.

**PIECE MAP**

The c-file, d-file, and minority-attack squares matter. Bishops often improve after central exchanges. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

**WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG**

Holding an extra c4 pawn can cost too much development; returning it at the right moment is often best. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

**POSITION SNAPSHOT**

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, Black pawn on c6, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d5, White pawn on e3, Black pawn on e6.

**WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?**

One of chess's most reliable and educational opening complexes, sound at every level.

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named D45 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to D45 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**001 Semi-Slav Defense: Accelerated Meran Variation**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 a6

**002 Semi-Slav Defense: Main Line**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3

**003 Semi-Slav Defense: Normal Variation**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7

**004 Semi-Slav Defense: Normal Variation**

1. Nf3 d5 2. e3 Nf6 3. c4 c6 4. Nc3 e6 5. b3 Bd6 6. Bb2 O-O 7. d4 Nbd7

**005 Semi-Slav Defense: Normal Variation**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. b3 Bd6 7. Bb2 O-O 8. Be2

**006 Semi-Slav Defense: Rubinstein System**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Ne5

**007 Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Qc2

**008 Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation**

1. d4 d5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. c4 c6 4. e3 e6 5. Nc3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 Bd6 7. b3

**009 Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation**

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 b6 7. b3

## COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

# Every named D45 line

This section preserves all 15 names and defining routes assigned to D45 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

**010**    **Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation**  
1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 b6 7. b3 Bb7

**011**    **Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation**  
1. d4 d5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. c4 c6 4. e3 e6 5. Nc3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 Bd6 7. b3 O-O 8. Bb2

**012**    **Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation, Center Variation**  
1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 Bd6 7. e4

**013**    **Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation, Center Variation, Mikhailchishin Line**  
1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 Bd6 7. e4 dxe4 8. Nxe4 Nxe4 9. Qxe4 e5 10. dxe5

**014**    **Semi-Slav Defense: Stoltz Variation, Shabalov Attack**  
1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Nbd7 6. Qc2 Bd6 7. g4

**015**    **Semi-Slav Defense: Stonewall Defense**  
1. d4 d5 2. Nf3 Nf6 3. c4 c6 4. Nc3 e6 5. e3 Ne4 6. Bd3 f5